

OTESSA 2025 Online Conference Program

May 25, 2025 @ 1:13 pm PDT (UTC-07:00)

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Welcome



Figure 1: OTESSA Logo

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

All OTESSA Participants can attend the [Congress “Big Thinking” lecture series](#). These take place each day of the conference. Congress has “[open events](#)” available as well (open to registrants across association conferences at Congress as well as those who hold community passes).

All OTESSA Registrants can also attend conference sessions offered by the [Canadian Association for the Study of Education \(CSSE\)](#), [Canadian Association for the Study of Higher Education \(CSSHE\)](#), and [Canadian Association of Learned Journals \(CALJ\)](#) as we have reciprocity agreements in place. Please note that presenters must register in each conference in which they are presenting.

Monday, June 2

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

8:30 - 9:00 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

9:00 - 10:00 | Keynote: Thomas Reeves

10:00 - 10:15 | Break

10:15 - 11:15 | Concurrent Session 1

(60 Mins)

Session 1.1

10:15 - 11:05 | Time Barriers for Adopting Digital Tools in Language Teachers' Practice

Research

Maryam Elshafei | *York University*

Abstract

An entire sub-field within language teaching has emerged exploring how technology can be used to mediate language learning, yet the impact of using these technologies on teachers is rarely discussed. Institutions and researchers seem to echo the affordances of digital tools and their transformative potential for improving student outcomes. At the same time, they have been blaming teachers for not using technology to its full potential, framing teachers as lacking the skills or beliefs for not using educational technologies in their teaching (Ertmer & Ottenbreit-Leftwich, 2010; Orlando, 2015). One of the major constraints that seems to be raised but dismissed in the literature is time. Teachers have expressed the lack of time over and over again, but there seems to be a lack of interest in addressing this problem (Atabek, 2019; Kopcha, 2012; Lawrence, 2018). Demanding teachers use their time to integrate edtech affects their personal and instructional time and their ability to exert agency over their time, and thus needs to be acknowledged and rewarded.

Session 1.2a

10:15 - 10:35 | Expectations for Generative AI Integration in Pedagogical Strategies

Research

Enas Aref et al. | *Western Michigan University*

Abstract

The global interest in integrating Generative Artificial Intelligence (Gen AI) tools in education is on the rise. While such integration provides potential advantages for all elements of the educational procedures, yet several questions remain unanswered. These questions inquire about the effective utilization of those tools and how to integrate them with pedagogical strategies. In this research, we will conduct a scoping review to acquire information about the essential components to create suitable frameworks of AI-integrated tools within strategies, educators' perceptions of the usability of those frameworks, and the challenges and benefits of those frameworks. The findings will provide comprehensive insights that will benefit educators in understanding the effective ways to integrate AI tools with pedagogical strategies. Also, it will benefit students by providing them with appropriate instructional design that fits with their goals and meets their needs. In this presentation, the researchers will provide a comprehensive overview of this work in progress (WIP) project and will share some of the preliminary findings.

Session 1.2b

10:35 - 10:55 | Evaluating Esports Tutorials through AI and Human Methods: Unpacking Learning Strategies in Open Digital Spaces

Track

Bruce Parsons et al. | *Radford University*)

Abstract

This short session examines the intersection of open educational resources (OER), esports instructional videos, and emerging AI evaluation methods. We detail how researchers employed AI-driven and human-coded instruments to identify, assess, and compare behaviorist, constructivist, and cognitivist strategies in esports tutorial videos available openly on YouTube. The study reveals how digital media, influenced by technology and open practices, provides fertile ground for informal learning to inform educational scholarship and practice.

Session 1.3a

10:15 - 10:35 | Reframing Presence in Fully Online Learning: Embracing Imagination, the More-than-human, and Sustainability

Practice

Susanna Kohonen | *University of Eastern Finland*

Abstract

In the context of fully online learning, higher education students have been found to struggle with feelings of isolation, lack of experience of presence, and lack of meaningful connections. These in turn have a negative effect on learning outcomes. To tackle these challenges, the presentation proposes drawing on posthumanist and socio-materialist thought. How to foster a sense of presence and togetherness in digital learning spaces is a question many online teachers, including myself, find challenging to answer. Are synchronous online sessions the only plausible option? This presentation aims to challenge our imagination by reflecting on both theoretical underpinnings and practical steps for educators to create more inclusive online learning environments that may enable opportunities for experiencing presence, ultimately aiming to reframe the concept of togetherness in fully online education.

Session 1.3b

10:35 - 10:55 | Modelling Students Emotional Trajectories in Course Evaluations: A Computational Framework for Enhancing Student Success

Research

Christel Young et al. | *East Tennessee State University*

Abstract

This session introduces the Emotional Trajectory Model (ETM), a computational framework designed to explore the emotional dimensions of student feedback in high-enrollment, introductory courses. Drawing on data from six semesters of the Using Information Technology course at a large public university, this exploratory research captures student sentiment from end-of-semester evaluations to better understand how students emotionally engage with course content, instruction, and learning experiences.

11:15 - 11:45 | Break

11:45 - 12:45 | Concurrent Session 2

(60 Mins)

Session 2.1

11:45 - 12:35 | AI and Human-Centered Open Education: Sopala: An Innovative Model for K-12 Education

Research

Sadik Shahadu et al. | *Affiliation*

Abstract

“The proposed presentation is part two of a study shared in the June 2024 OTESSA conference and published in a proceedings paper. Author et al.’s (2023) review of the alignment between design principles (Crichton & Author, 2022) and the National Standards for Quality Online Learning (NSQOL 2019a, 2019b, & 2019c) and the Quality Matters standards (QM, 2016a, 2016b) concluded that most standards served as exam-

ples of components that could be found in an effective model or a course without a clear picture of what they comprise collectively. As the researchers found a stronger alignment with the research-based Quality Matters (QM, 2016a, 2016b) than the NSQOL standards, the Community of Inquiry (Garrison et al., 2000) was explored as the COI was used as a framework for the Standards for K-12 Online Learning in British Columbia (BC Ministry of Education, 2021). This session will focus on the alignment of the design principles with the COI's thirty-four-question survey (Arbaugh et al., 2024). Reference will also be made to other quality frameworks, including the Quality Matters K-12 rubrics and instructor skills set (QM, 2016a, 2016b) and First Peoples Principles of Learning (FNESC, 2020). The analysis led to a potential model to guide the development of engaging and supportive online learning that will be shared. Researchers also plan to share it with online educators and revise the model and the design principles. The design principles specific to post-secondary preparation, continuing research, and teacher well-being were not reflected in either the COI model or standards. Further research is required to determine intersection points between all three specific to online course design and instruction benchmarks. It is hoped that basing the design principles in the context of research-based models will further develop an understanding of quality in K-12 online learning and inform K-12 online practice."

Session 2.2a

11:45 - 12:05 | Exploring the Alignment of Design Principles for K-12 Online Learning with Researched Models and Standards: Principles to Guide Engaging and Supportive Online Learning

Research

Randy LaBonte et al. | *CANeLearn*

Abstract

The proposed presentation is part two of a study shared in the June 2024 OTESSA conference and published in a proceedings paper. Author et al.'s (2023) review of the alignment between design principles (Crichton & Author, 2022) and the National Standards for Quality Online Learning (NSQOL 2019a, 2019b, & 2019c) and the Quality Matters standards (QM, 2016a, 2016b) concluded that most standards served as examples of components that could be found in an effective model or a course without a clear picture of what they comprise collectively. As the researchers found a stronger alignment with the research-based Quality Matters (QM, 2016a, 2016b) than the NSQOL standards, the Community of Inquiry (Garrison et al., 2000) was explored as the COI was used as a framework for the Standards for K-12 Online Learning in British Columbia (BC Ministry

of Education, 2021). This session will focus on the alignment of the design principles with the COI's thirty-four-question survey (Arbaugh et al., 2024). Reference will also be made to other quality frameworks, including the Quality Matters K-12 rubrics and instructor skills set (QM, 2016a, 2016b) and First Peoples Principles of Learning (FNESC, 2020).

Session 2.2b

12:05 - 12:25 | Addressing the Assumption that Online Learning is Intuitive: An OER for Learning to Learn Online

Practice

Kristin Petrovic et al. | *Athabasca University*

Abstract

“Primary and secondary schooling in North America is generally situated around the traditional model of in-person teaching and learning. As such, when entering post-secondary education, most people already have a sense of how to learn in the place-based setting. However, if moving to a different mode of education, such as the online environment, it is essential to support the necessary shift in understanding how to learn within this context.

To meet the needs of those learning to learn online, faculty from programs including Counseling Psychology and Undergraduate and Graduate Nursing in the Faculty of Health Disciplines at Athabasca University collaborated to adapt an e-book open educational resource (OER) to facilitate how to adjust and thrive in the online learning environment. In this presentation, we share the overall aim of adapting this OER, the main topics addressed in the e-book, as well as processes and practices that the faculty implemented as they collaborated to develop and adapt this resource. Finally, we share recommendations related to supporting learners to learn online as well as our strategies for addressing the pragmatic aspects of adapting an OER for use across different programs in an online post-secondary environment.”

Session 2.2c

12:25 - 12:45 | Yes, You Can: Research With Adult Trauma Survivors Who Learn Online

Practice

Hilary Schmidt | *Thompson Rivers University*

Abstract

Trauma-informed pedagogy and educational practices are rapidly gaining traction in higher education, with increasing interest from faculty and staff, administrators, and government policymakers (see, for example, Government of British Columbia, 2023). While the volume of scholarly publications in these areas has increased rapidly over the past few years, literature on trauma-informed pedagogy and practice in postsecondary education continues to consist primarily of practitioner reflections, with a paucity of empirical research (Anderson et al., 2023). As far as I am aware, my own publications (Author, 2023, 2024, in press) comprise the first peer-reviewed research to examine trauma-informed practice for open/online higher education. Given survivors' preference for hybrid and online learning (Werkmeister, 2024), the relative lack of research in this area represents a troubling gap. Particularly concerning is the dearth of scholarly literature that centres survivors as learners, contradicting the fundamental principle of collaboration in a trauma-informed approach.

This session aims to support educational researchers contemplating or embarking upon collaboration with adult trauma survivors who learn in open and online settings. Using evidence from prior studies and meta-analyses, the session will dispel common myths (e.g., “survivors are too fragile to participate” or “you’ll never get research ethics board approval”) and dismantle barriers that may discourage researchers from engaging in these projects.

Based on my experience conducting a study with adult complex trauma survivors who learn online, and grounded in the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Service Administration’s (SAMHSA’s) (2014) classic guidelines for trauma-informed practice, the session will provide practical guidance for implementing respectful, collaborative research relations with survivors who in open and online settings; ensuring safety for researchers and participants; and attaining institutional research ethics board approval.

Session 2.3a

11:45 - 12:05 | “Generating” Equity? Why Generative AI-Powered Education Necessitates Integration of Critical Algorithm Studies

Research

Fatima Zohra | *University of Waterloo*

Abstract

To what extent can AI-powered technologies, particularly Generative AI (GenAI), further exacerbate societal inequities? In Ruha Benjamin’s award-winning book, *Race Af-*

ter Technology, she conceptualizes “the New Jim Code” as “The employment of new technologies that reflect and reproduce existing inequities but that are promoted and perceived as more objective and progressive than the discriminatory systems of a previous era” (5-6). GenAI is a critical example of a “new technology” that is “computational” – and therefore perceived to be “objective” and “logical” – yet threatens to reinforce the same existing inequities for marginalized people that can weaponize Large Language Models (LLMs) for information warfare. In *Artificial Unintelligence*, Meredith Broussard argues against “technochauvinism” – the belief that complex problems can always be solved with the right technological solutions – proposing that social issues will not disappear in a digital utopia. Hence, this presentation examines three core areas through which GenAI can pose detrimental harms for society: (1) AI “hallucinations” and mis/disinformation; (2) mass data collection; (3) biased prompt engineering. The examination of these areas builds on existing scholarship on the harms of GenAI (Ferrara, 2024; Mazurczyk et al., 2023; Menczer, 2023) ultimately leading to the proposition that the integration of GenAI in classrooms requires a simultaneous integration of critical algorithm studies so students (and educators) are well-versed in the nuances of GenAI ethics. This is especially pertinent in cases where younger students who may have very limited knowledge of how LLMs work (especially in regard to mass data collection) are increasingly using GenAI for schoolwork. For example, this presentation demonstrates how varied levels of “prompt tuning” can skew generated outputs in LLMs followed by a rhetorical analysis of the broader implications of such nuances in “research” generation – particularly how such manipulation of GenAI models (even inadvertently) can be detrimental for academic research and writing. Thus, this presentation provides practical recommendations for GenAI integration through sample demonstrations, activities, and case studies that can be conducted in the classroom to create awareness of the risks of inequities posed by GenAI thereby underscoring that the promise of GenAI to exponentially increase efficiency and scalability for optimal results across disciplines – including education – must be critically evaluated (Aksoy & Kursun, 2024). The perils of algorithmic discrepancies are echoed by critical algorithm studies scholars who have established that algorithms are becoming increasingly powerful and capable of influencing socio-political change (Benjamin; Noble; O’Neil; Broussard). Ultimately, this presentation provides a novel conceptualization of the implications of GenAI in education through the lens of Open Educational Resources (OER) and Open Educational Practices (OEP) that are increasingly harnessing the power of GenAI to not only generate resources but also evaluate assessments. Examining how such technological infrastructures are (re)shaping pedagogy – and education more broadly – is critical for addressing how the lack of rigorous regulation of these technologies threatens to exacerbate existing inequities and obstruct the democratization of knowledge.

Session 2.3b

12:05 - 12:25 | Exploring Students' Perceptions, Practices, and Training Needs Regarding Generative AI

Research

Marta Samokishyn et al. | *Saint Paul University*

Abstract

The rapid popularity and adoption of generative AI tools are transforming how students learn, research, and create. Generative AI tools, such as ChatGPT, Copilot, and Gemini, are becoming ubiquitous in educational environments, yet little is known about how university students use them. This study investigates students' use, attitudes, and beliefs surrounding these powerful technologies, aiming to identify critical gaps in understanding, perceived challenges, and necessary training interventions. Our research addresses several key questions: (1) How are students currently utilizing generative AI in their academic work? (2) What are their perceptions of the benefits and risks associated with these tools? (3) What misconceptions or knowledge gaps exist regarding the functionality, limitations, and ethical implications of generative AI? (4) What challenges do students face in effectively and ethically integrating these tools into their learning processes? Finally, (5) what targeted training and support structures are needed to empower students to leverage the potential of generative AI responsibly and effectively? This presentation will provide actionable insights for educators, librarians, and administrators seeking to address students' use of AI in educational environments and explore what training opportunities would benefit students at this time.

12:45 - 1:00 | Break

1:00- 2:30 | Networking

Tuesday, June 3

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | James Slotta - Future of Ed Tech

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Concurrent Session 3

(60 mins)

Session 3.1

11:15 - 12:05 | Integrating Artificial Intelligence into a Community of Inquiry: The Roles of AI

Practice

Hyeyung Park | *Athabasca University*

i Abstract

The Fifth Industrial Revolution (5IR) highlights the collaboration between humans and technology, emphasizing sustainability, human-centeredness, and environmental responsibility. Artificial intelligence (AI) is a transformative force reshaping instructional design by partnering with learners, addressing individual needs, and fostering personalized

learning. This research explores AI applications in instructional design and strategies to overcome challenges in AI integration. Using a three-level model as a learning theory, it examines the roles of AI for individual, team and organizational learning. Furthermore, this study provides practical insights for integrating AI into a community of inquiry (CoI) framework to enhance learning design. The dearth of research on the roles of AI within the CoI framework has made it difficult for practitioners to employ AI in instructional strategies effectively. This paper addresses this gap by proposing AI roles grounded in a three-level model and offering practical insights on integrating AI into a CoI framework. Ultimately, it empowers practitioners to leverage AI effectively, maximize its potential benefits, and address challenges proactively through a theory-informed approach.

Session 3.2

11:15 - 12:05 | Ethical AI in Open Education: Balancing Innovation, Accessibility, and Digital Equity

Practice

Warren Wilansky | * *

Abstract

“AI is rapidly reshaping digital education, from automated grading and personalized learning experiences to AI-powered knowledge management and research tools. However, these advancements come with critical ethical concerns, including bias, misinformation, privacy risks, and accessibility barriers. As higher education and open learning communities increasingly adopt AI, it is vital to ensure these tools promote inclusion and equitable access rather than reinforcing existing inequalities.

In this session, Warren Wilansky, Founder & President of Plank, will explore how AI is transforming digital education and open scholarship, while addressing the challenges of ensuring accessibility, ethical use, and digital equity. ”

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 4

Session 4.1

12:45 - 1:35 | Designing Calm: Reducing Learner Anxiety with H5P in Digital OER Textbooks

Workshop or Demo

Theresa Huff | *Loyola Marymount University*

i Abstract

“Anxiety is a pervasive challenge in online learning, significantly affecting learner engagement (Beattie, 2022), retention (Rosser-Majors et al., 2022), and success (Akpen et al., 2024). While previous research has focused on fostering belonging (Narla et al., 2024), enhancing peer and instructor connections (Hoferichter et al., 2022), and providing mental health support (Brewer, 2023), little attention has been given to the role of instructional design in addressing learner anxiety. This interactive workshop bridges that gap by demonstrating how thoughtfully applying four multimedia principles—segmenting, generative activities, feedback, and emotional design—through H5P and images in open digital textbooks can reduce anxiety and foster more inclusive, calming online learning environments.

This workshop builds on a qualitative study of 50 online college students who completed an interview survey exploring the application of these multimedia principles across six scenarios in a digital textbook. The findings highlight that all four principles helped relieve anxiety, with varying degrees of effectiveness. Segmenting had the most consistent impact, with H5P tools like the Course Presentation and Accordion being highly effective in reducing text overload, improving perceived efficiency, and giving learners control over content. Generative activities and feedback, as applied in H5P Quizzes, alleviated anxiety by promoting self-assessment and validating knowledge, though Interactive Videos sometimes caused anxiety due to interruptions in flow and a “test-like” feel. Emotional design, when applied using H5P Audio, helped reinforce key concepts and engage learners, but rounded, warm-colored images were less effective in reducing anxiety.

In this session, participants will explore examples of instructional materials that integrate these principles, comparing versions with and without their application. A hands-on segment will guide attendees in creating their own H5P content—such as reflective exercises, visual content, or formative assessments—and embedding it into a Pressbook. Participants can follow along or observe, depending on their preference. Open discussions

will invite attendees to consider how these techniques can be applied to reframe “togetherness” in online learning, fostering connection by addressing shared challenges like anxiety.”

Session 4.2a

12:45 - 1:05 | Mid-American Conference Websites and Student Well-Being: A Content Analysis

Research

Hui Zhan | *Ohio University*

Abstract

In this study, we investigate the twelve Mid-American Conference (MAC) universities' websites, aiming to assess how they articulate well-being components outlined in the inter-association definition of well-being. Our results suggest that universities are prioritizing different components of well-being from an individual and a community level, underscoring the significance of employing the inter-association definition to guide the assessment.

Session 4.2b

1:05 - 1:25 | Creating Whiteboard Animations to Explain Tooth Microanatomy

Practice

Nazlee Sharmin et al. | *University of Alberta*

Abstract

“The knowledge of tooth microanatomy is a cornerstone of dental education. However, teaching this complex concept in an engaging manner is challenging for many educators. The rapid development of digital instructional tools has enormous potential for the design and development of engaging and effective teaching resources; whiteboard animation is one of them. Whiteboard animation refers to a specific style of animated videos where the content appears to be hand-drawn on a school whiteboard and narrated in a storytelling manner. This technique uses cartoons and line drawings rather than live videos and realistic images. Whiteboard animations have all the benefits of traditional animations, illustrating an abstract idea, simplicity, and engagement. However, the feature that

makes whiteboard animations stand out as an educational tool is their ability to combine visual thinking and storytelling (Adams, 2020).

Storytelling is a multimodal teaching approach that simultaneously engages listeners' thinking, emotions, and imagination (Crocetti & Barr, 2020). However, this powerful tool is underutilized in higher education, particularly science education (Kokkotas, Rizaki, & Malamitsa, 2010; Krupa, 2014). Whiteboard animations, powered by storytelling, have been successfully applied to explain complex health-related topics for medical and pharmacology students (Larnard et al., 2020). Studies also showed that this animation technique positively affects the retention, engagement, and enjoyment of university-level students (Li et al., 2019)."

Session 4.2c

1:25 - 1:45 | Developing a Mobile App for Oral Histology

Practice

Nazlee Sharmin et al. | *University of Alberta*

Abstract

Mobile devices have become an integral part of our everyday life. The widespread use of this technology has emerged in the mobile-enabled teaching and learning era, also known as m-Learning [1]. m-Learning is gaining popularity in health professional education; however, reports on mobile apps targeting didactic teaching and learning of histology are scarce. Histology is an essential foundational component of dental and medical education. At the Mike Petryk School of Dentistry, University of Alberta, instructors use photomicrographs from textbooks to teach students the microanatomy of teeth, the development of tooth and facial regions, and developmental anomalies. The lack of high-quality tissue sections and insufficient class time challenge both students and instructors [2]. To provide students with an accessible collection of diverse histological sections and to facilitate in-class didactic teaching, we developed an Augmented Reality (AR)-based mobile app called Tooth ARcademy.

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

2:00 - 3:00 | Concurrent Session 5

(60 Mins)

Session 5.1

2:00 - 2:50 | **Speculation: Shaping the Future of Education**

Practice

Danielle Dilkes | *Western University*

Abstract

“Higher education is currently in a period of great uncertainty, starting with the lasting impacts of the disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, and perpetuated by myriad new potential and actual disruptions emerging globally including Generative AI, climate change, global conflicts, changing public funding models, and increasing corporate influence on education, to name a small few.

In this time of great disruption, we are constantly, through action or inaction, in a global process of remaking the world and reshaping education. The possible futures of education are impacted by our collective social imaginations and by who has the power and resources to design the future (Benjamin, 2024).

Speculation, understood here as the art of imagining possibilities, is a powerful tool for shaping this future. Speculations can perform as a cautionary tale, similar to the fairy tales of the past, to draw attention to dark possibilities (Krutka, 2021) and focus our attention on things that we need to explicitly engage with or actions we need to take to avoid these undesirable futures or to “to give warning when we see ourselves drifting in dangerous directions” (Butler, 2000). It can also be used as a source of critical hope, to expand our minds to allow us to imagine radical change for the better (Houlden & Veletsianos, 2023). Importantly, speculation is a tool available to everyone, not just the elite, allowing a more collective approach to future design by those who choose to engage in speculative work.

This workshop will introduce the concept of speculative storytelling, drawing heavily on the work of Octavia Butler (2000) and Donna Haraway (2021) as well as speculative design methodologies (Dunne & Raby, 2013), future-making from design anthropology (Akama et al., 2018) and speculative education fiction from critical education studies (Houlden & Veletsianos, 2023; Krutka et al., 2021). We will look at how speculation has been used in various contexts as a tool for future-making and design and discuss specifically how it can be a useful tool for creating the futures that we want (and need) in higher education.

Participants will engage in reflection and micro-storytelling activities throughout the session, providing them with tools for speculative thought and empowering them to contribute to future-making in their own contexts.”

Session 5.2

2:00 - 2:50 | Transformative Digital Accessibility and Post-Secondary Teaching Praxis

Workshop or Demo

Kim Ashbourne et al. | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

“Digital accessibility is more than a technical/compliance issue. It is a dynamic socio-cultural phenomenon that occurs when people with disabilities, and those using assistive technologies, can equitably and agentively: find, understand, navigate, engage in, and contribute to information sharing, information production, and sociocultural experience sharing in digital environments with others (Author, 2025; Web Accessibility Initiative, n.d.). It is dependent on the ways digital technology, content, environments, and experiences are designed, used, and shared but it’s also dependent on sociocultural factors. Digital accessibility is not often presented to educators this way, or as a topic for personal reflection, pedagogical exploration, or as a praxis of freedom.

If digital accessibility is presented to educators at all, it is typically presented as a set of technical how-tos relative to compliance with legislation, such as the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (2005). This technical/compliance-lens framing has done educators and learners a disservice by focusing on the “requirements” rather than on inclusion and transformative learning experiences.”

Wednesday, June 4

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Anatoliy Gruzd - From Prompt to Propaganda: How Generative AI Fuels Disinformation and Misinformation and What We Must Do

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Keynote | Laura Czerniewicz, Catherine Cronin, Helen Beetham

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 6

(60 mins)

Session 6.1

12:45 - 1:35 | **Open Publishing Unplugged: Unlocking Creativity and Collaboration**

Workshop

Karna Younger et al. | *Loyola Marymount University*

Abstract

“A proven equity strategy in education (Hilton, 2019; Colvard et al., 2018), open educational resources (OER) creation and remixing should be a collaboration to ensure OER are supportive of a inclusive, diverse, and equitable learning experience (Sergiadis et al., 2024). This session offers a behind-the-scenes look at collaboratively guiding 11 teams of 39 faculty from four colleges and universities as they created and remixed OER in 11 different fields of study. Through their community building, the presenters modeled transparency, creativity, and collaboration, creating brave spaces for faculty to explore and share their own OER journeys.

Participants will gain insight into the joys and challenges of managing a large-scale collaboration. Challenges included scheduling across four institutions, creating templates and frameworks to guide the process, and ensuring alignment with diversity, equity, inclusion, and anti-racism (DEIA), accessibility, copyright, and instructional design best practices. To support these efforts, the presenters developed an OER faculty handbook, which includes practical guidance on integrating DEIA into OER, making OER accessible, aligning content with learning objectives, and designing interactivity using Pressbooks and H5P. By simultaneously creating their own OER faculty handbook and transparently sharing their wins and fails, the presenters modeled the process, encouraged faculty to innovate boldly, and celebrated their own learning through presentations, goodie bags, and community recognition.

This session will include live demonstrations of interactive, objective-aligned H5P tools and OER texts in Pressbooks from the OER faculty handbook and faculty teams’ work. Participants will explore sections of the OER faculty handbook, such as the OER Tool Look Book, backward design for OER, and strategies for engaging faculty learners. Group discussions will focus on collaboratively problem-solving challenges in building OER communities and brainstorming strategies for success.”

Session 6.2a

12:45 - 1:05 | **MicroDesign in Open/Higher Education**

Practice

Hilary Schmidt et al. | *Thompson Rivers University*

Abstract

“In this session, we will briefly define and describe microlearning and explore participants’ prior understanding of and engagement with microlearning as designers, teachers, and learners. We will demonstrate an asynchronous, online microlearning project that we created. We will discuss instructional design considerations and support participants in considering where and how they might create their own microlearning lessons.

Microlearning is an established technique for learning and development in many workplaces, with the recognition that busy professionals face constraints on their learning time. A microlearning approach is both convenient and effective; it can enhance learning outcomes and improve retention of information and skills, while reducing cognitive load by delivering information in digestible, focused segments (Taylor & Hung, 2022). Shifting from a more traditional, time-intensive approach, microlearning is tightly focused, aiming to support effective, just-in-time learning (Alias & Razak, 2024). Despite the benefits of microlearning, adoption has been limited in higher education contexts for both faculty and students (Corbeil & Corbeil, 2023; Lockley, 2024).

Harnessing the advantages of a microlearning approach, we created a suite of asynchronous online microlearning lessons (MicroDesign) to enable busy faculty members to grasp fundamentals of open/online course development in interactive, asynchronous online lessons of 5 minutes or less. In the session, we will share an example: a high quality, interactive microlearning lesson that explores copyright compliance (a critical responsibility for course developers, particularly in an open learning context).

In the session, we will tell the “story” of the design process. As well, we will discuss the technology used to build and host MicroDesign, provide additional examples of microlearning for a postsecondary audience, and share a template to guide participants’ planning of their own microlearning possibilities.”

Session 6.2b

1:05 - 1:25 | Virtual Reality Museums: Redefining Engagement and Understanding in Cultural Heritage

Practice

Yuning Gao | *New York University*

Abstract

This session explores the development of a Virtual Reality (VR) museum dedicated to the banjo, tracing its cultural and historical significance. Designed as part of a graduate research project, this immersive learning environment aims to enhance accessibility,

engagement, and storytelling within digital museum experiences. By leveraging design thinking principles, 3D modeling, and interactive elements, the VR museum bridges gaps in traditional curation, offering visitors an enriched, self-guided exploration of the instrument's evolution and social impact. The presentation will outline key phases of the project—from initial research and prototyping to user testing and iteration—highlighting both challenges and unexpected insights. Rooted in a commitment to inclusivity and experiential learning, this work aligns with the conference theme, Reframing Togetherness, by fostering new ways of connecting with history, technology, and diverse audiences. Attendees will gain practical takeaways for integrating VR into educational and cultural spaces, as well as insights into designing immersive experiences that prioritize accessibility and engagement.

Session 6.2c

1:25 - 1:45 | AI as Creative Writing Coach: Exploring Human-AI Collaboration in Creative Writing Learning

Research

Cinzia Pusceddu | *Affiliation*

Abstract

What role can AI play in creative writing learning beyond simply generating or editing text? My research investigates the potential of generative AI as a collaborative partner in creative learning, focusing on its role in prompting the writer's reflection rather than contributing directly to the writing itself. Drawing on enactivist theory's (1) view of learning as emerging through interaction and posthumanist perspectives on non-human agency, I intend to examine how sustained AI-human dialogue influences creative development and writing processes. The research combines autoethnography to document the writer's subjective experience with thing ethnography (2) to capture AI's role as an active participant, producing both theoretical insights into human-AI collaboration and a literary work that emerges through this process. The resulting creative piece serves as both artwork and case study, embodying the research findings and demonstrating how AI-human creative partnerships affect creative choices, self-reflection, and artistic development.

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

2:00 - 3:00 | Concurrent Session 7

Session 7.1

2:00 - 2:50 | Exploring the Intersection of Agriculture, Technology, and Game-Based Learning

Workshop

Patricia Dennis | *Independent*

i Abstract

This conference session, “Exploring the Intersection of Agriculture, Technology, and Game-Based Learning: Empowering Students to Investigate Beneficial Pollinator Bugs with Minecraft Education,” will delve into the innovative integration of agriculture and technology through game-based learning (GBL). Recognizing the critical role of pollinator bugs in agriculture, this session will demonstrate how Minecraft Education can be leveraged as a powerful tool to engage students in understanding and preserving these essential species. Participants will experience a live demo play of the designated Minecraft Education adventure, showcasing how interactive gameplay can simulate real-world agricultural environments. This immersive experience will allow students to investigate the life cycles, habitats, and contributions of pollinator bugs to ecosystems and food production. The session will also cover strategic and beneficial note-taking methods to enhance learning outcomes. Attendees will explore practical strategies for educators to incorporate technology and GBL into their curricula, fostering student engagement and enhancing STEM education. By blending these elements, educators can inspire students to develop a deeper appreciation for environmental sustainability and agricultural science, equipping them with the knowledge and skills needed to address future challenges in food security and biodiversity conservation. Attendees will leave with actionable insights and resources to implement this innovative approach in their own educational settings.

Session 7.2

2:00 - 2:50 | Educational Pathways to Access, Support, Hope, Transformation, and Opportunities (ePASHTO)

Practice

Marguerite Koole | *University of Saskatchewan*

Abstract

“In August 2021, the Taliban returned to power in Afghanistan. Their policies resulted in 1.4 million girls losing access to education (Pan, 2023) with both secondary and tertiary education forbidden. While access to primary education is permitted, 30% of young girls never attend for sociocultural, economic, and safety reasons. Female teachers and professors are no longer permitted to work. The humanitarian costs of barring women and girls from basic education is significant on personal, social, and economic levels.

Distance education and generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) could offer some pragmatic solutions. “Artificial intelligence refers to the ability of computer systems to mimic human intelligence” (Bowen and Watson, 2024, p. 16). Generative means that “they can produce novel outputs of the same general kind as their training data” (Vallor, 2024, p. 19). GenAI trains on images, text, sound, and even video. The large language models basically predict which words connect to each other. Mollick (2024) describes GenAI as an “elaborate autocomplete” like what is on a smartphone (p. 9). Nevertheless, GenAI can interact with a human-like competence which—albeit has limitations—can still offer a means of supporting learners.

GenAI could provide a way to interact and practice language skills, receive personalized feedback, and access educational content tailored to individual needs. Abram (2025) argues that GenAI tools can assist with translation, adaptive learning, creation of and modification of lessons, motivation, interaction, as well as assessment and evaluation. In this online presentation, we will present and discuss a series of vignettes. Each vignette will provide three educational scenarios faced by women and girls in Afghanistan. We will address biases, hallucinations, social justice, and the possible goals of ‘big tech’. We will examine how GenAI can 1) help learning/teaching, 2) hinder learning/teaching, and/or 3) present risks.

Any solutions to the problem of access to education must address the current socio-cultural, political, economic, geographic, and infrastructural conditions of Afghanistan. Years of war interrupting school attendance and now the prohibition of education for roughly half of the population (women) has resulted in large learning gaps and very diverse learning needs across the entire population (Abrams, 2025). With this in mind, this presentation will not only explore GenAI opportunities but also the risks for Afghan women and girls—including the risk of doing nothing (Abram, 2025).”

Thursday, June 5

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Jennifer Wemigwans - Remote from Congress in Toronto

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Concurrent Session 1 | Streamed from Victoria

(60 Mins)

Session 1.1a

Location

11:15 - 11:35 | Creating Capacity for Digital Transformation

Research

Leah Macfadyen | *University of British Columbia*

Seyyed Kazem Banihashem | *Open University of the Netherlands*

Rhiannon Lewis | *University of British Columbia*

Abstract

Globally, the demand for online education has surged, driven by the need for flexible and accessible learning (Johnson, 2023; Quality Matters, 2023) and dramatically escalated by the COVID-19 pandemic (Cui et al. 2022). In 2024, Cui et al. noted that doctoral level education in educational technology will “build critical capacity for leading research and driving transformation in policy and practice”. In this study we contend that while doctoral-level expertise and leadership is vital, it is widespread access to flexible post-graduate education and training for current and upcoming educators and practitioners that will support system-wide upskilling for ongoing digital transformation. In 2019, and in 2024, we surveyed the global landscape of masters-level education related to educational technologies and digital learning. Currently, 39 institutions offer 65 master’s degree programs in this field. Surprisingly, only eight new master’s degree programs in educational technology launched globally, post-pandemic. However, we did discover extensive curricular rebalancing. Here, we report on the current state of master’s level education in educational technology, curricular expansions in topic areas that including management, planning and leadership, research methods, technical aspects of design, data and analytics, emerging issues & technologies, and instructional strategies, and we consider how these reflect current educational needs.

Session 1.1b

11:35 - 11:55 | Cultivating GenAI Literacy – Moving Past AI Pedagogy’s Hype

Research

Gwen Nguyen | *BCcampus*

Abstract

In this session, I examine the relationship between GenAI and pedagogy in higher education, challenging the notion of AI pedagogy while advocating for critical and mindful integration of AI tools within existing pedagogical frameworks. Drawing on the recent literature on digital pedagogies and practical experiences, I argue that while AI tools can enhance educational outcomes, they cannot replace the fundamental human elements that define true pedagogy, including empathy, ethical reasoning, critical thinking, and creativity. This session aims to contribute to the ongoing dialogue about the role of AI in higher education by proposing a practical framework for cultivating AI literacy among educators while maintaining the essential human-centered approach to teaching and learning.

Session 1.2

Location

11:15 - 12:05 | Assessment for Equity: Openness and DEI in your grading architecture (WorkShop)

Workshop

Colin Madland & Jess Mitchell | *University of Victoria & Ontario College of Art and Design University*

Abstract

This workshop will provide an overview of how you can use your grading architecture (how you lead learners through activities that support their learning, and ultimately, how you arrive at a final grade) to support greater equity using openness and DEI in your assessment practice. Equity is compromised when grades are assigned based on anything other than what a learner knows or can do (e.g., arbitrary due dates, punitive policies, etc.). Openness is compromised when learners, instructors, or other stakeholders do not fully understand the meaning and implications of the grades that are assigned. Bring your syllabus and join us as we explore ways to build assessment architectures that ensure grades are assigned according to what learners know and that learners understand how to progress in their learning journey based on the feedback you provide. We will discuss the purposes of assessment, sources of inequity in grading and how to overcome them, effective communication of feedback, instructor workload, and resources to assist you in your journey into alt-grading practices that meet you where you are.

12:15 - 1:30 | Lunch

1:30 - 2:30 PDT | Keynote | George Veletsianos

2:45 - 3:45 | Concurrent Session 2

(60 Mins)

Session 2.1a

Location

2:45 - 3:05 | Social Representations of Parents from Rural Areas Regarding Access and Use of Digital Technology

Research

Pascal Gauthier, Eve Pouliot, & Patrick Giroux | *Université du Québec à Chicoutimi*

Abstract

From the very beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic, digital technologies proved to be essential for the functioning of society (INSPQ, 2021). However, behind the apparent “hyperconnectivity” of young people, they are not exempt from digital inequalities (CEFRIO, 2017), and most importantly, they are not innate experts in these technologies (Yagoubi, 2020). Moreover, parents are the closest authority figures to young people regarding the “virtual world” (Reginasari et al., 2021). On the other hand, they may experience a certain ambivalence towards digital technology. Using the conceptual framework of social representations (Moscovici, 1961, 1976), this qualitative research, originating from a master’s thesis in social work, analyzes the discourse of 10 parents living in rural areas of Saguenay-Lac-Saint-Jean during the COVID-19 pandemic. The results indicate that they acquired knowledge of videoconferencing, which allowed them to continue their daily lives and ensure their children’s education. Some were able to develop a more positive attitude towards technology, while others experienced exhaustion or fatigue related to digital usage. Additionally, parents have a techno-deterministic view of digital technology and remain under the impression that young people have abilities they themselves do not possess (the “digital native” myth). This study can help professionals better understand the digital issues faced by parents and integrate them into their practice, whether in social work or the educational field.

3:05 - 3:25 | Digital Learning for Innovative Teaching: Adopting a Competency-Based Approach

Practice

Tanya Elias | *University of Calgary*

Abstract

“The Digital Learning Competency Framework developed at Vancouver Community College organizes 21 discrete competencies into three categories and seven sub-categories. Together, these competencies delineate essential digital knowledge, skills and attitudes for instructors and other learning practitioners. Each competency is further defined at four levels of proficiency so that all learning practitioners, regardless of their starting

point, can easily engage in meaningful and applied learning paths aligned with their specific needs. These competencies are now being used to develop a Digital Learning For Innovative Teaching (DLIT) microcredential that will offer formal, for credit online learning opportunities with recognition via digital badges and a short certificate. There is also future potential for the Digital Learning Competency Framework, and an associated open challenge bank, to be used to develop and recognize less formal digital learning professional development via portfolio assessment, workshops and other formats. This session discusses the Digital Learning Competency Framework development process, its current uses and the potential to extend its use over time.

Session 2.2

Location

2:45 - 3:35 | Designing Assessment As, Of, and For Learning with GenAI tools (Workshop)

Workshop

Gwen Nguyen | *BCcampus*

Abstract

When discussing assessment, we often focus primarily on assessment of learning (summative) and assessment for learning (formative). In this interactive session, we will explore how GenAI tools can be integrated across the full spectrum of assessment practice: as, of, and for learning. The session will start with a discussion on the theoretical foundations of different types of assessment and their intersection with GenAI tools, followed by practical demonstrations of how GenAI tools can enhance assessment strategies. Participants will actively engage in designing multi-layered assessment activities that promote student engagement and autonomy, utilizing GenAI in an ethical and meaningful way.

3:45 - 4:00 | Break

4:00 - 5:00 | Concurrent Session 3

(60 mins)

Session 3.1a

Location

4:00 - 4:20 | Exploring the Opportunities and Limitations of Immersive Technologies in Education

Research

Jangchu Tenzin | *University of New Brunswick*

 Abstract

Session 3.1b

Location

4:20 - 4:40 | 3D Printing Resources for the Elementary Classroom

Research

Brittany Johnson & Krystal Yang | *University of Victoria*

 Abstract

Session 3.2

Location

4:00 - 4:50 | AI, Oh My! Teaching, Cheating, and Surviving the ChatGPT Era

Research

Jill Robinson, Jhotisha Mugon, Jessica Rourke | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

The widespread gain in popularity of artificial intelligence, such as ChatGPT, has taken higher education by storm. This has resulted in instructors adapting their pedagogical approach, feeling pressured to continuously make changes to assessments and the ways in which they engage students. Instructors and students express various sentiments about AI, ranging from positive beliefs and excitement, to fear and uncertainty. In this session we will present concerns about the use of AI in the classroom, challenges to implementation of AI, and solutions focusing on the ethical and pedagogical use of AI in higher education.

Using data from a survey of university instructors, we will present themes from a qualitative analysis of responses to several AI and teaching-related questions, examining such things as familiarity with AI, supports needed for implementation, and trends across courses. We will also consider ethical implications and unintended consequences of technological interventions, emphasizing the importance of aligning digital tools with pedagogical goals. We discuss literature related to student engagement, academic integrity, and the evolving role of AI in education. By combining real-world perspectives from faculty with a critical review of emerging solutions, we aim to provide a balanced perspective on integrating AI technology into teaching pedagogy.

Friday, June 6

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

9:10 - 10:10 PDT | Presidential Address | Valerie Irvine (UVic) & Stephanie Moore (UNM)

10:15 - 11:15 PDT | Keynote | Jean-Paul Restoule (UVic)

11:30 - 12:30 | Concurrent Session 4

Session 4.1

11:30 - 11:35 | Instructional design analytics in practice: Converting a multi-course graduate bridging program from blended-synchronous to blended-asynchronous delivery using risk-based and qualitative research techniques

Practice

Deborah Exelby | *Athabasca University*

i Abstract

Identifying which synchronous teaching-learning activities in a blended learning program should/could be converted to asynchronous technology-enabled delivery is a real-world problem encountered by many instructional designers. Risk-based instructional design analytics are an effective, efficient, and evidence-based approach for identifying misaligned

learning outcomes and content gaps; appropriate teaching-learning activities; justifiable delivery and interaction methods; and targets to concentrate time, effort, and resources for meeting learning objectives and redesign parameters. This ‘how to’ presentation will outline a solution for restructuring an existing multi-course higher education program using a risk-based mapping process for curriculum analysis and redesign decision-making. How a current state curriculum was coded, analyzed, and reorganized using triangulation of three sequential techniques is presented: 1) mapping of program (PLO) and course learning outcome (CLO) mastery requirements based on Bloom’s taxonomy (introduce, reinforce, mastery); 2) coding PLO failure risk based on the potential impact of not learning the content to the required mastery level (low, medium, high); and 3) sorting of CLOs based on keywords, into topics (course lessons) and then into themes (courses). This session demonstrates how instructional design analytics were used successfully in real-world practice to codify and sort existing curricula for program redesign.

Session 4.2a

Location

11:30 - 11:50 | Open Access and the Habitual Use of Crown Photography of Indigenous Children: Ethical Implications

Research

Shawl-Song | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

The go-to images representing the history of Canada’s Indian Residential Schools (IRS) are of identifiable Indigenous children. As technological advances afford open access to the now digitized photographs, consideration for the child’s right to agency over self is often ignored. Using a social semiotic framework, historical images present alongside paradigmatic relationships to demonstrate the gaps apparent between ethics, Copyright Canada law, child advocacy and social norms. Hundreds of unpublished analogue photographs have passed into provincial and federal archival holdings where copyright remains in perpetuity with the Crown. In cases of academic research and curriculum content design, ethics approval or community engagement are currently not needed when utilizing these images. Many of these children could still be alive today and hold no agency over the photographs. While copyright law serves to protect the creators and users of a photograph, there are no ethical guidelines for the use, dissemination or protection of images of children. This presentation concludes with the demonstration of an interactive reflexive

tool developed from the author's master's thesis. This tool facilitates ethical consideration beyond the systemic use of 'Fair Dealing for Educational Purposes' and may serve to highlight efforts around the privacy and protection of children in research and education.

12:30 - 1:45 | Lunch

1:45 - 2:05 | Publication Pathways | Michele Jacobsen (UCalgary) & Valerie Irvine (UVic)

2:05 - 2:15 | Break

2:15 - 3:15 | Session 5

Session 5.1

Location

2:15 - 2:35 | Developing the Technology-integrated Assessment Scale

Research

Colin Madland | *University of Victoria*

i Abstract

“This presentation will highlight the process of building and testing a new scale intended to help researchers understand the Technology-integrated Assessment Framework (TIAF) and how it functions in higher education. In 2024, we published a description of the development of the TIAF (Madland et al., 2024), highlighting four factors related to technology-integrated assessment: (1) assessment purposes, (2) the duty of care owed by instructors to learners, (3) factors influencing technology acceptance, and (4) assessment design. Our current work is focused on understanding how these four factors within the TIAF framework can be operationalized. We will share our process of designing the scale, including defining the key constructs, identifying parameters, and framing parameters as items on the scale. We will also share preliminary results from our pilot study using the first draft of the scale. This session will be of interest to undergraduate and graduate students as well as researchers, faculty members, and administrators seeking to refresh

their skills in scale development and anyone interested in assessment in higher education.

Session 5.2a

Location

2:15 - 2:35 | From Mobile Learning to Artificial Intelligence: Evolving UTAUT Constructs in Educational Technology Adoption

Research

Caleb Or | *Singapore Institute of Technology*

Abstract

Forthcoming

Session 5.2b

2:35 - 2:55 | The Impact of Sense of Belonging on Emotion Regulation in Online Collaborative Learning: A Cross-Case Comparison of Small Groups

Research

Yeeun Choi & Mariel Miller | *University of Victoria*

Abstract

This study explores how a sense of belonging impacts the regulation of emotion in the face of challenge during online collaboration. A cross-case analysis was conducted between two groups who experienced similar emotions during a negative experience but reported contrasting levels of sense of belonging. Data include video recordings of collaborative exams and post-exam reflections to gain in-depth qualitative insights into learners' perceptions and regulation strategies. By adopting self-regulated learning (SRL) framework, the study seeks to understand how students cope with negative experiences during collaboration, and to what extent their sense of belonging impacts their strategic management of challenges. Findings inform evidence-based guidelines for designing online collaborative learning experiences that not only support students' emotion regulation but also create supportive online environments.